

JEONG YAKYONG

Korean scholar, philosopher, and poet
1762–1836



Jeong Yakyong was a young man in his twenties when he became one of the most trusted advisers to the Korean ruler King Jeongjo. At this time, new ideas from China and Europe were flooding into Korea. Jeong was brilliant at collecting and looking into the new pieces of information. He figured out how to combine them with traditional ideas. Like the king, Jeong wanted to use science and technology to improve how Korea was run. He worked closely with the king to plan changes to the country.

Today, Hwaseong Fortress is protected and celebrated as an UNESCO World Heritage site.



Jeong Yakyong is also known as "Dasan."

At the age of 31, Jeong was put in charge of the construction of a new fortress for Korea's capital city. He used the best ideas and new technology, such as complex cranes, to design a fort that was both beautiful and brilliantly designed to keep out attackers.

In a world before computers, Jeong used writing to record other people's ideas and to come up with new ones. He wrote almost 2,500 poems and more than 500 books, on a huge range of topics—from politics and science, to music and medicine.

